

Daily Need to Know

Wednesday, 30 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — TUESDAY 29 SEP SETTLE · CLOSED 04:00 GMT+8, ~2.2 HOURS OLD AT CAPTURE			
S&P 500	7,670.84	▼ -12.85 (-0.17%)	Range 7,653.6–7,699.6; closed at 38% of it. Low was 4.5 points under the ~7,658 negative-gamma line Keith cited Monday. 48.7% of band 7552–7796; 1.9% off high.
Nasdaq Composite	26,797.54	▼ -22.84 (-0.09%)	Semis up, Apple down: a wash. 26.8% of band; 1.8% off high.
Dow Jones	51,349.92	▼ -131.59 (-0.26%)	Apple and J&J (–1.6%) the drag. 6.2% off high.
Russell 2000	2,807.92	▼ -9.99 (-0.35%)	Closed below Monday's band floor (2,808) — Hedgeye cut the floor 17 points to 2,791 overnight. 18% of new band; 8.5% off high.
Philadelphia SOX	12,629.17	▲ +163.93 (+1.32%)	Best index: Applied Materials +5.2% , Broadcom +1.6%, Micron +1.1% the day before it reports. Still 13.8% off high.
INDEX FUTURES — TUESDAY SETTLE, DEC CONTRACTS · GLOBEX REOPENED 06:00 GMT+8; THE 10-MINUTE-DELAYED FEED SHOWS NONE OF THE NEW SESSION			
ES (Dec)	7,732.00	▼ -14.75 (-0.19%)	Basis to cash +61.2 — normal December carry, which confirms a settle, not a live print. 1.54m contracts.
NQ (Dec)	30,613.25	▲ +47.00 (+0.15%)	Up while the Composite fell: the Nasdaq-100 carries the semis; QQQ +0.19%.
YM (Dec)	51,702	▼ -135 (-0.26%)	Basis +352 to cash Dow; settle.
RTY (Dec)	2,829.2	▼ -10.9 (-0.38%)	Basis +21.3; settle. Weakest future.
TREASURY YIELDS — TUESDAY CLOSE			
US 10-year	5.234%	▼ -0.2bp	Traded 5.293% intraday — a 52-week high, 0.3bp through today's new 5.29 ceiling — then gave it all back. 78.5% of band 5.03–5.29.
US 30-year	5.566%	▲ +1.6bp	Only tenor higher. Intraday 5.619% was a 52-week high; CNBC reported it as the highest since 2002.
US 5-year	5.048%	▼ -2.4bp	Held above 5% after first crossing it last week.
US 2-year	4.879%	▼ -5.2bp	Hit 4.960% intraday, a 52-week high. 53% of Hedgeye's 4.74–5.00 band. 2s10s +35.5bp , from +30.5bp.
13-week bill	4.169%	▲ +0.7bp	Unmoved: the front end is pricing the policy path, not the data.
COMMODITIES — ENERGY AND COMEX AT TUESDAY SETTLE; SPOT METALS ~9 MINUTES INTO THE NEW SESSION			
WTI (Nov)	89.38	▼ -3.22 (-3.48%)	Saudi East-West pipeline back to ~half capacity; SPR release of up to 40m bbl. \$2.29 above the lowered band floor (14.5%).
Brent (Dec)	96.16	▼ ≈-1.66 (-1.7%)	The feed prints -8.66% : that is a roll artefact against the expiring November (settled 102.59, –2.6%). Nov-Dec backwardation \$6.43 . See \$18.
Natural gas	3.011	▼ -0.095 (-3.06%)	Second –3% day; 34.8% of a band whose floor was cut 8¢.
RBOB gasoline	3.1323	▼ -0.0255 (-0.81%)	Fell far less than crude: the crack widened on the day.
Gold (spot, live)	4,182.75	◆ +1.01 (+0.02%)	~9 minutes of session, range \$4.55: noise . Comex front settled 4,179.70 (+0.27%); GLD +1.3%. 43.3% of bearish band 4100–4291.
Silver (spot, live)	61.644	◆ +0.190 (+0.31%)	Noise-length session. Comex settled 61.153 (–0.92%). 60.7% of a band whose floor was cut \$2.
Copper (spot, live)	6.5578	◆ -0.0017 (-0.03%)	34.7% of band 6.44–6.78. Comex HG settled 6.6035 (–0.45%), which would misread as 48%.
DOLLAR, VOLATILITY, CRYPTO			
DX1	101.376	▲ +0.202 (+0.20%)	Tuesday's move; 0.42 below the 101.80 52-week high. 72.8% of a band raised at both ends.

USD/JPY (live)	157.26	◆ -0.03 (-0.02%)	FX rolled 05:00 GMT+8: ~69 minutes of session, range 5 pips — noise .
USD/KRW	1,351.38	▼ -8.40 (-0.62%)	Range 1,350–1,360 is Tuesday's Seoul session: the won strengthened as Samsung and SK Hynix rebounded.
VIX	16.03	▼ -0.05 (-0.31%)	54.5% of bearish band. Equity vol flat while MOVE +4.7% to 106.6 .
Bitcoin (live)	83,522	◆ +46 (+0.06%)	The only genuinely live 24-hour row. 24h range 82,741–84,495; 33.8% below the 126,230 high. Keith's buy level ~80,416.

Colour key: ▲ up · ▼ down · ◆ flat or noise-length session. All levels TradingView, captured 06:09:37–06:09:39 GMT+8. Cash prior closes reconcile exactly to Monday's settles printed in yesterday's edition; WTI, Brent (Dec), S&P and Nasdaq closes independently match wire copy (\$18). Yahoo was rate-limited and returned nothing.

TL;DR

- Oil broke lower:** WTI –3.5% to **\$89.38**, \$2.29 above a Hedgeye floor that was itself cut \$3.44 — the "first significant lower high" Keith named. Hedgeye cut Brent to minimum size.
- The consumer cracked:** Conference Board confidence **81.9 vs 89.2** expected, lowest since 2014; JOLTS **7.079m vs 7.228m**. The 2-year fell 5.2bp; the 30-year still rose to a 52-week high. Curve +5bp steeper.
- Credit is at the edge:** HYG closed **1¢ above** a lowered floor after printing a 52-week low below it. LQD and TLT also set 52-week lows.
- Tonight:** August PCE at **20:30 GMT+8** (core +0.3% m/m expected), then Micron at **04:30 Thu**. Hedgeye's Quad Count is now printed: **2-2-1-2-2**.

2 The big picture — what it means

- The data finally turned, and the long end did not care.** Confidence missed by 7.3 points and JOLTS by 149k. The 2-year fell 5.2bp from a 4.960% intraday high; the 30-year rose 1.6bp to close at 5.566% after **5.619%**. A weaker consumer bought the front end a rally and bought the long end nothing. That is a term-premium problem, not a growth-scare rally.
- Oil is doing the Fed's work for it.** WTI is down **\$3.22** on supply relief — Saudi pipeline restoration, Middle East exports at a war-time high of 12.8m b/d (Kpler), and an SPR release. The Conference Board's own economist said mentions of oil and gas prices "rose to new heights" in the survey. Cheaper crude is the one lever that eases both inflation and confidence at once.
- Hedgeye's bond call has a named exit, and it is not here yet.** The 10-year band moved to **5.03–5.29** — a higher high, not the lower high Keith says will end the short. The 10-year pierced 5.29 intraday and closed 5.6bp under it. Keith notes 5.29% is roughly the 2007 peak.
- Credit is closer to breaking than equities.** HYG printed 77.16, a 52-week low, and closed at 77.36 against a floor of 77.35. Keith puts high-yield spreads near the **300bp** threshold he treats as a breakout. The S&P, by contrast, sits at 49% of its band.
- The flow backdrop is thinning.** The Macro Show relayed Tier 1 Alpha's view that gamma is approaching flat-to-negative with up to **~\$30bn** of net selling possible in the buyback blackout. The S&P's low of 7,653.55 already traded under Monday's ~7,658 gamma line. Third-party estimate; not verified here.
- Megacap leadership is fragmenting.** Meta +3.2% and Apple –2.7% on the same AI-assistant story; Nvidia –0.7% closed at 3% of its range two sessions after a \$150bn buyback increase. The Nasdaq-100 rose while the Composite fell. Leadership is by name, not by theme.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- Curve:** twist steepener. 2s10s **+35.5bp** (from +30.5bp), 10s30s **+33.2bp**. The 2-, 5-, 10- and 30-year all printed 52-week intraday highs on Tuesday.
- Rates vol:** MOVE **106.6** (+4.7%) against VIX 16.0. Hedgeye's PFIX long (rate-volatility hedge) is the expression Keith called one of his strongest calls.
- Dollar:** DXY 101.38, 0.4% below its 52-week high; EUR/USD 1.1342, 0.3% above its 52-week low. Band raised 19¢/17¢ — a higher high.
- Crude structure:** Brent Nov-Dec at **\$6.43** backwardation into Wednesday's November expiry; Brent (Dec)–WTI (Nov) **\$6.78**, down from ~\$11.9 on Friday's front months. The spread compression is partly the roll.
- Products:** RBOB –0.8% against crude –3.5%; diesel remains the tight barrel. Washington is weighing diesel-export curbs and red-dyed diesel relief (Rigzone, Yahoo).
- Metals:** gold bearish TREND, ceiling cut \$40; spot 4,182.75 at 43% of band. Silver floor cut \$2 to \$58. Copper bullish TREND, bearish TRADE per Keith.
- Gas:** \$3.011, –3.1%; floor lowered 8¢ to 2.83.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

SIGNAL	READING	SOURCE & TIME (GMT+8)
Regime	#Quad2 . The US "accelerated into a MONTHLY #Quad2 in SEP 2026"; four of the next five months nowcast as #Quad2 through January 2027.	Early Look, Tue 29 Sep 19:27
Quad path	NOW PRINTED: 2-2-1-2-2 (Quad Count, as "AI and our Algos read it"). Yesterday's edition had no explicit notation, so this is the first printed path in this run of editions, not evidence of a change. The Macro Show summary says the projected path "eventually includes Quad 4" — presumably beyond January; unreconciled.	Early Look 19:27; Macro Show notes 22:32
Rates	Short TLT and ZROZ, unchanged. Exit trigger: lower highs in the 2-year and 10-year bands. 2-year band 4.74-5.00% ; Alpha Codes 2Y 4.55/4.30, 10Y 4.90/4.70.	Early Look 19:27
Book	Long XLV, XLE, PFI, CLOX, PANW, BUG, CVI, Brent, BTC, ETH, USD. Short TLT, ZROZ, XLY, XLF, XLI, IWM, HYG, gold, INDA, EWA, EWG, EWL, QAT.	Macro Show notes (AI summary) 22:32
Changes	Brent cut to minimum size ; part of crack-spread sold; CVI bought on the dip. ETF Pro: +CRTC, +XLK, +QTUM longs; JETS and PRN shorts covered . Signal Strength: 54 stocks (2 added, 1 removed) — names not extractable.	Macro Show 22:32; ETF Pro 22:21; SSS 22:54

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look "Choosin' #Quad2 Texas", Tue 29 Sep 07:27 ET (19:27 GMT+8), Keith McCullough

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	PRIOR (28 SEP)	Δ FLOOR / CEILING	WIDTH	WHERE IT STANDS NOW
UST 10-year	5.03-5.29	bullish	5.02-5.26	+0.01 / +0.03	0.24→0.26	5.234 — 78.5%. A higher high : the opposite of Keith's exit signal. Intraday 5.293 pierced it.
High Yield (HYG)	77.35-78.37	bearish	77.63-78.71	-0.28 / -0.34	1.08→1.02	77.36 — 1%, 1¢ above the floor . Low 77.16 was a 52-week low, below it.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	102.0-104.6	bearish	102.6-104.8	-0.60 / -0.20	2.20→2.60	102.41 — 16%. Floor cut 60¢, the second cut running; 52-week low 102.04.
S&P 500	7,552-7,796	bullish	7,550-7,765	+2 / +31	215→244	7,670.84 — 48.7%. Ceiling restored after Monday's 32-point cut. Keith: 1.7% down vs 1.5% up, "a fair fight".
Nasdaq Comp.	26,505-27,596	bullish	26,419-27,611	+86 / -15	1,192→1,091	26,797.54 — 26.8%. Band narrowed from below.
Russell 2000	2,791-2,884	bearish	2,808-2,888	-17 / -4	80→93	2,807.92 — 18%. Closed under the old floor ; the band followed price down.
Health Care (XLV)	167-173	bullish	166-172	+1 / +1	6→6	170.73 — 62%. Shifted up a dollar.
Software (IGV)	103-109	bullish	103-109	0 / 0	unchanged	Not in capture universe; position unknown.
Energy (XLE)	61.00-64.96	bullish	60.90-65.57	+0.10 / -0.61	4.67→3.96	61.54 — 13.6%, 54¢ above floor . Ceiling cut for a second day.
Volatility (VIX)	14.22-17.54	bearish	14.32-17.80	-0.10 / -0.26	3.48→3.32	16.03 — 54.5%. Band lowered at both ends.
US Dollar (USD)	100.27-101.79	bullish	100.08-101.62	+0.19 / +0.17	1.54→1.52	101.376 — 72.8%. Higher high; ceiling now near the 101.80 cycle high.
Crude, WTIC cont.	87.09-102.87	bullish	90.53-105.85	-3.44 / -2.98	15.32→15.78	89.38 on CL1! — 14.5%, \$2.29 above floor. Largest move in the table ; the lower high Keith flagged.
Nat gas cont.	2.83-3.35	bullish	2.91-3.35	-0.08 / 0	0.44→0.52	3.011 — 34.8%.
Gold spot	4,100-4,291	bearish	4,111-4,331	-11 / -40	220→191	

4,182.75 on TVC:GOLD — 43.3%. Lower high; the short is working.

Copper spot	6.44–6.78	bullish	6.41–6.80	+0.03 / -0.02	0.39→0.34	6.5578 on OANDA spot — 34.7%. Comex HG misreads 48%.
Silver spot	58–64	bearish	60–64	-2 / 0	4→6	61.644 — 60.7%. Floor cut \$2; band widened by half.

Prior bands from Mon 28 Sep Early Look ("Another #Quad2 Week, It Was"), as reproduced in the archived 29 Sep edition; the category feed does not paginate. Positions use Tuesday closes for cash, ETFs and yields; TVC/OANDA spot for metals; continuous contract for crude and gas. These bands were published before Tuesday's session. Wednesday evening's Early Look (~19:30 GMT+8) supersedes this set.

Band moves in one line. No TREND signal changed. Crude's band fell furthest (floor −\$3.44, ceiling −\$2.98); gold's ceiling was cut \$40 and silver's floor \$2. HYG, LQD, RUT, VIX and XLE's ceiling were all lowered. The 10-year and the dollar made **higher highs** — the two signals Keith says keep the #Quad2 trade on.

What Keith actually said

Early Look, Tue 29 Sep 07:27 ET / 19:27 GMT+8: "To start The Game, the US economy accelerated into a MONTHLY #Quad2 in SEP 2026". On the path: "*Quad Count: The way AI and our Algos read it is 2-2-1-2-2." On the exit: "WHEN the Risk Range™ Signals start signaling LOWER-HIGHS, that's when I know even The Express himself may have reached exhaustion". And: "For now, however, we're still short Treasuries via TLT and ZROZ".

Macro Show, Tue 29 Sep (summary posted 10:32 ET / 22:32 GMT+8). The summary is AI-generated and carries Hedgeye's own error caveat, so it is reported here without quotation marks. Keith read the 2-year's push to ~4.95% alongside the dollar breakout as markets pricing further Fed tightening. He reduced Brent to minimum size after WTI's first significant lower high, and sold part of the crack spread. High-yield spreads near 300bp are a potential breakout; the HYG short stays. He noted Nvidia gained only ~1.7% on its buyback headline while short-dated call buyers lost money.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
Nvidia NVDA	227.21	▼ -1.65 (-0.72%)	\$5.48trn	Closed at 3% of its range , one day after the \$150bn buyback bump. The reaction, not the headline, is the signal Keith flagged.
Apple AAPL	329.40	▼ -9.00 (-2.66%)	\$4.81trn	Worst megacap: reports CEO John Ternus is weighing a leaner, engineering-led reorganisation, plus a BofA note on Meta's Muse eroding product discovery. Closed at 8% of range.
Alphabet GOOGL	340.92	▼ -1.83 (-0.53%)	\$4.15trn	Mid-range; 16.6% below its high, the second-furthest in the group.
Microsoft MSFT	508.96	▼ -0.26 (-0.05%)	\$3.78trn	Flat; range 502–514. 8.1% off high.
Amazon AMZN	246.67	▲ +0.52 (+0.21%)	\$2.66trn	Keith: Amazon signalling bearish TREND inside his XLY short. Reported to be blocking Muse.
Meta META	738.79	▲ +23.17 (+3.24%)	\$1.88trn	Best megacap, closed at 93% of range , after two −3%+ days. Muse has signed Shopify, Expedia and PayPal commerce access.
Tesla TSLA	352.84	▼ -4.61 (-1.29%)	\$1.39trn	29.3% off high. Keith: breaking TREND. Q3 deliveries expected this week (date unconfirmed).

Tuesday closes. Caps are TradingView market cap basic. Combined Mag7 ~\$24.15trn, down ~\$0.15trn on the day. Postmarket moves across the capture universe were within ±1%; largest Workday −0.9%, Oracle +0.6%, Micron +0.5%.

6 Positioning & options

- **Gamma:** per the Macro Show, Tier 1 Alpha sees gamma still positive but approaching flat-to-negative, with one-month vol near crossing above three-month. The S&P's 7,653.55 low traded below Monday's ~7,658 line; it closed 13 points above. Third-party estimate.
- **Flows:** up to ~\$30bn of net selling possible if flows reverse inside the buyback blackout (Tier 1 Alpha via Keith).
- **Short-dated calls:** failed 0DTE call buying in SPY and Nvidia cited as upside chasing without follow-through.
- **Vol split:** VIX 16.03 is mid-band; MOVE 106.6 is up 4.7% in a day. Bond vol is doing the work equity vol is not.
- **Breadth:** equal-weight RSP −0.11% vs SPY −0.18%; Russell −0.35%. No breadth signal either way on the day.
- **Micron implied move:** options pricing for Wednesday's report was not captured this run.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR	CLOSE	DAY	OFF 52W HIGH	READ
Utilities XLU	39.71	▲ +1.17%	16.9%	Led, closed at 88% of range — bought on the front-end rally.
Comm. Services XLC	111.47	▲ +0.26%	7.4%	Meta.
Industrials XLI	169.13	▲ +0.21%	10.1%	Hedgeye short. Holds Equifax and TransUnion, both lower on the FHFA scoring change.
Cons. Discretionary XLY	109.15	▲ +0.14%	12.7%	Carnival up double digits offset Tesla. Hedgeye short.
Technology XLK	194.50	◆ -0.02%	2.1%	Semis up; Apple and Fair Isaac down. Closest to its high; new ETF Pro long.
Real Estate XLRE	41.34	◆ -0.02%	11.0%	No bid from the 2-year rally.
Health Care XLV	170.73	▼ -0.31%	3.3%	J&J -1.6%, UNH -0.8%. Hedgeye long.
Financials XLF	54.01	▼ -0.33%	7.8%	Hedgeye short; added to ETF Pro Monday.
Cons. Staples XLP	81.85	▼ -0.52%	9.2%	Closed at 97% of range after a weak open.
Materials XLB	49.10	▼ -0.75%	9.4%	Copper and silver softer.
Energy XLE	61.54	▼ -0.90%	7.0%	Worst sector; 54¢ above its Hedgeye floor. Hedgeye long.

- **Leaders:** utilities and semis — the two ends of a "rates down at the front, AI still bid" day.
- **Laggards:** energy, materials, staples — commodities and the consumer, i.e. the day's two data points.
- **Rotation:** Hedgeye's two sector longs (XLV, XLE) both lost; its three sector shorts (XLY, XLF, XLI) split. A poor day for the book's sector legs; the macro shorts were mixed — TLT -0.5% helped, gold (Comex +0.3%, GLD +1.3%) did not.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Overnight tape. There is none yet. Globex reopened at 06:00 GMT+8 and the capture ran at 06:09 on a 10-minute-delayed feed, so every futures row is Tuesday's settle: ES 7,732 (-0.19%), NQ 30,613 (+0.15%), YM 51,702, RTY 2,829. The only live signals are spot FX (69 minutes, flat) and Bitcoin (flat at 83,522). Asia opens into Tuesday's US close, not into a fresh overnight move.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Wed 30 Sep, 19:30	Hedgeye Early Look — new risk-range set supersedes \$4.
Wed 30 Sep, 20:30	US August PCE: headline +0.4% m/m (~3.8% y/y), core +0.3% m/m (~3.4% y/y) expected. Personal income/spending; Q2 GDP third estimate. September ADP (time unconfirmed).
Wed 30 Sep	ICE Brent November contract expires. US federal fiscal year ends.
Thu 1 Oct, 04:30	Micron FQ4 results — the first read on memory pricing after the SOX's +1.3% bounce.
Thu 1 Oct	Mainland China and Hong Kong National Day holiday (typical; not confirmed against exchange calendars this run). BOJ Tankan typically released this morning — unconfirmed.
Thu 1 Oct, 20:30 / 22:00	Initial claims; ISM Manufacturing (Sep) ; construction spending.
Fri 2 Oct, ~04:15	Nike FQ1 results (after Thursday's US close).
Fri 2 Oct, 20:30	September nonfarm payrolls , unemployment rate, hourly earnings; factory orders.

Calendar from TradingKey's weekly preview; consensus figures are TradingKey's and were not cross-checked against a second calendar.

9 Corporate news

- **Fair Isaac (FICO):** fell by **20-27%** intraday (outlets differ; close not captured) after FHFA Director Bill Pulte said Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac will move to one pricing grid with VantageScore alongside FICO Classic. Rocket Mortgage said it will prioritise VantageScore. Equifax and TransUnion also fell.
- **Carnival (CCL):** record Q3 revenue, net yields and net income; FY26 EPS guidance raised. Shares **+11.7% to +13%** depending on outlet. Close not captured.
- **Oracle (ORCL):** **+3.91% to 137.79** on the Fusion Claw agentic-AI launch and reports of fast OpenAI revenue growth. Still **57%** below its 52-week high of 322.54. +0.6% after hours.

- **Apple (AAPL):** -2.66% on reports of a leaner reorganisation under CEO John Ternus — engineering director and programme-manager cuts, trims to Vision Pro, Siri and Fitness+ — and a BofA note on Meta's Muse.
- **AMD:** agreed to buy World Labs for **\$8.2bn**, bringing in Fei-Fei Li. Shares flat at 607.57.
- **Applied Materials (AMAT):** +5.19% to **512.01**, best of the capture universe; no single catalyst reported.
- **Oura** delayed its US IPO, citing market uncertainty.

10 Macro data

- **Conference Board confidence (Sep):** **81.9** vs **89.2** consensus; prior 88.6. Lowest since 2014. Present situation 109.3 (-7.9); expectations **63.6** (-5.9). Net views of business conditions turned negative for the first time since September 2024.
- **JOLTS (Aug):** openings **7.079m** vs **7.228m** consensus; prior 7.335m (MarketScreener). A 256k drop in a month.
- **Dallas Fed manufacturing (Sep, Monday):** expected 7.3 vs 11.6 prior; actual not captured.
- **RBA** raised its cash rate 25bp to **4.60%** on Tuesday (Invezz). Keith cited it as a central bank reacting late to the cycle.
- **Japan:** 10-year JGB yield around **3.09%** (Invezz).

11 Geopolitics

- ♦ **US-Iran:** officials held "separate indirect talks with mediators" on reopening Hormuz (CNBC, TheStreet). Trump rejected an Iranian proposal on 26 Sep (Washington Post) and told Axios he expects talks this week. Rigzone describes the talks in New York as making minimal progress, with the conflict in its eighth month.
- ▼ **Oil supply relief:** Saudi Arabia restored roughly half of East-West pipeline capacity after drone damage (Rigzone). Middle East crude exports reached **12.8m b/d** in September, highest since February (Kpler, via Yahoo), largely through costlier ship-to-ship workarounds.
- ▼ **SPR:** the administration is releasing up to **40m barrels** (Rigzone).
- ▲ **Diesel:** Washington is weighing export curbs; EU officials hope they will not materialise (Rigzone). Diesel is the barrel the Iran and Russia-Ukraine wars have squeezed hardest.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	STATUS
ES / NQ	7,732.00 / 30,613.25	-0.19% / +0.15%	Tue settle; vol 1.54m / 572k
YM / RTY	51,702 / 2,829.2	-0.26% / -0.38%	Tue settle; vol 76k / 172k
USD/JPY	157.26	-0.02%	Live, 69 min; 5-pip range
USD/KRW	1,351.38	-0.62%	Tuesday Seoul session
USD/TWD	31.824	+0.04%	Tuesday session
USD/CNH	6.7073	-0.01%	Live; 0.2% above 52w low
EUR/USD	1.1342	+0.02%	Live; 0.3% above 52w low
Gold / Silver (spot)	4,182.75 / 61.644	+0.02% / +0.31%	Live, ~9 min
Copper (spot)	6.5578	-0.03%	Live, ~9 min
WTI (Nov) / Brent (Dec)	89.38 / 96.16	-3.48% / -1.7%	Tue settle
Bitcoin / Ether	83,522 / 2,681	+0.06% / -0.25%	Live 24h

- **Handover:** US semis (SOX +1.3%, AMAT +5.2%, Micron into results) and lower crude. That favours Korea and Taiwan chip names and oil importers.
- **Previous Asian closes (Tue, ~15 hours old):** Nikkei **65,481** (-0.60%; Invezz had -1.2% at 65,071 intraday), KOSPI **6,871** (-0.27%), Hang Seng 24,524 (-0.48%), Shanghai 3,830 (+0.18%), ASX 200 8,709 (+0.34%), Sensex 72,529 (-0.33%, 1.4% above its 52-week low; a Hedgeye short).
- **Korea:** Samsung and SK Hynix rebounded Tuesday after 5%+ losses Monday, and the won firmed 0.6%. KOSPI remains below the 7,052 TREND level Hedgeye cited Monday.
- **Japan:** Topix fell ~1.8% Tuesday (Invezz) as US 10-year yields hit 5.27%+ and JGBs ~3.09%. Lower crude helps; the yen is flat.
- **China/HK:** last session before the 1 Oct holiday (typical; unconfirmed). CNH sits near its strongest of the year.
- **Single instrument most likely to move:** the US 2-year into tonight's PCE — Asia trades a holding pattern until 20:30.

13 AI watch

- **Anthropic prospectus:** Fortune reports a leaked S-1 showing Q2 2026 revenue of **\$11.5bn** (Q1 \$4.73bn), FY2025 revenue \$4.6bn and a \$42bn net loss, planned capex of \$518bn, and ~25% of revenue from two customers. Reports frame a ~\$2trn valuation. Risk factors include AI's potential "existential risk to humanity" (CNBC/Reuters). Offering terms and timing not disclosed.
- **OpenAI** delayed the GPT-6.1 "Astra" release over security concerns (TheStreet).
- **AMD-World Labs** (\$8.2bn) buys spatial-intelligence talent rather than revenue.
- **Meta Muse** is the AI story moving two megacaps in opposite directions: +3.2% for Meta, -2.7% for Apple.
- **Nvidia:** the \$150bn buyback increase has now produced +1.7% and -0.7%. The Macro Show debated whether buybacks at this valuation read as a growth signal or a capital-allocation question.
- **Oracle Fusion Claw:** agentic-AI product plus OpenAI revenue news lifted a stock still 57% off its high.

14 Beyond the markets

- **A K-shaped Tuesday:** consumer confidence at a 12-year low on the same day Carnival printed record revenue and net income. The survey's pain is prices; the cruise line's customers are not the survey's median.
- **Mortgage credit scoring changed overnight:** ending FICO's exclusivity at the GSEs, which back ~70% of US mortgages, is a structural change to how US housing credit is priced.
- **5.29%** is roughly where the 10-year peaked in 2007 (Keith). It traded 5.293% intraday Tuesday.
- **The long bond** closed at 5.566% with a consumer-confidence miss and falling oil — the two things that usually cap it.

15 Appendix — stock cards

MU · MICRON

1,065.08 ▲ +11.10 (+1.05%)

Cap \$1.20trn · 15.1% off 52w high 1,255 · +0.5% after hours · reports Thu 04:30 GMT+8

The week's single-stock event. Up into the print with the SOX; the memory complex (SanDisk +1.0%, WDC flat) is 26-43% off its highs.

AAPL · APPLE

329.40 ▼ -9.00 (-2.66%)

Cap \$4.81trn · 4.6% off high · closed at 8% of range

Reorganisation reports and the Muse threat on the same day. Test of the \$330 area it closed just under.

META · META PLATFORMS

738.79 ▲ +23.17 (+3.24%)

Cap \$1.88trn · 5.3% off high · closed at 93% of range

Recovered most of Monday's -4.8%. Muse's commerce partners are the bull case; the enterprise-AI spend that sank it Monday is unchanged.

NVDA · NVIDIA

227.21 ▼ -1.65 (-0.72%)

Cap \$5.48trn · 3.9% off high · closed at 3% of range

Largest company, weakest close. Keith is watching for lower highs after the buyback failed to lift it.

ORCL · ORACLE

137.79 ▲ +5.19 (+3.91%)

Cap \$417bn · 57.3% off high · +0.6% after hours

Fusion Claw plus OpenAI revenue news. Volume 45.6m, well above normal. A relief bounce inside a deep drawdown.

AMAT · APPLIED MATERIALS

512.01 ▲ +25.25 (+5.19%)

Cap \$406bn · 30.8% off high · closed at 91% of range

Led semis equipment. Still nearly a third below the 739.67 high.

TSLA · TESLA

352.84 ▼ -4.61 (-1.29%)

Cap \$1.39trn · 29.3% off high · Q3 deliveries expected this week

Keith says it has broken TREND; Hedgeye short XLY. Closed at 17% of range.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

607.57 ▼ -0.30 (-0.05%)

Cap \$992bn · 4.9% off high · range 605-624

World Labs deal (\$8.2bn) met with a shrug; gave up a 2.7% intraday gain.

16 About this edition

- **Covers:** the US session of Tue 29 Sep as settled (04:00 GMT+8), after-hours to 18:00 ET, and Hedgeye's full Tuesday publication set.

- **Captured:** 06:09:37–06:09:39 GMT+8 (2.2s), TradingView bulk scan; Yahoo returned nothing (rate-limited). Cross-checks against wire copy are in §18.
- **Timing:** run fired 06:09 GMT+8, nine minutes after Globex reopened. On a 10-minute-delayed feed that is **zero minutes** of new futures session. Spot FX has ~69 minutes, spot metals ~9, crypto is continuous.
- **Settled vs live:** cash equities, futures, yields, energy and Comex rows are Tuesday settles (~2.2 hours old). Spot FX, spot metals and crypto are live; their change figures are noise-length except crypto.
- **Hedgeye edition:** full subscriber feed reached. Live risk ranges are the Tue 29 Sep Early Look by Keith McCullough; Wednesday's ~19:30 GMT+8 edition supersedes it. Also read: Macro Show summary, ETF Pro update, Signal Strength header.
- **Quad path — FLAG:** printed explicitly for the first time in this run of editions: **2-2-1-2-2** (Sep 2026 → Jan 2027).
- **Not available:** Top 3 Things, Chart of the Day, MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant and Real-Time Alerts did not appear in the feed index; the Signal Strength list was not extractable.

17 Sources

Prices: TradingView scanner, 06:09:37–06:09:39 GMT+8 (96 instruments); Yahoo Finance attempted and throttled. Settle cross-checks from Rigzone (crude) and The Motley Fool (S&P, Nasdaq, Oracle).

Hedgeye: Early Look "Choosin' #Quad2 Texas" (19:27 GMT+8); Macro Show Summary Notes (22:32); ETF Pro Plus update (22:21); Signal Strength Stocks (22:54). Prior bands from the Mon 28 Sep Early Look via the archived 29 Sep edition.

Macro: Conference Board via Yahoo Finance and The Hill; JOLTS via MarketScreener and BLS release listing; calendar and consensus from TradingKey; RBA and JGB from Invezz.

Narrative and single stocks: TheStreet, Yahoo Finance, The Motley Fool, Invezz, Fortune, CNBC, Forbes and GuruFocus.

Commodities, geopolitics, AI: Rigzone, Yahoo Finance (Kpler data), CNBC, Washington Post, Axios, Fortune, CNBC/Reuters.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **capture.py reconciliation:** 0 match ($\leq 5\text{bp}$) · 0 minor · 0 divergent · **57 single-sourced**. There are no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran — Yahoo tripped its 429 circuit breaker (0/62). This is not a clean reconciliation.
- **Prior-close arithmetic:** close minus change reproduces Monday's settles exactly as printed in yesterday's edition — S&P $7,670.84 + 12.85 = \mathbf{7,683.69}$; Nasdaq $26,797.54 + 22.84 = \mathbf{26,820.38}$; Dow $51,349.92 + 131.59 = \mathbf{51,481.51}$; Russell $2,807.92 + 9.99 = \mathbf{2,817.91}$; SOX $12,629.17 - 163.93 = 12,465.24$ (printed 12,465.23, a rounding cent). ES $7,732.00 + 14.75 = \mathbf{7,746.75}$, Monday's settle.
- **Wire cross-check:** WTI Nov **89.38** (−3.5%) and Brent Dec **96.16** (−1.7%) match Rigzone's settle copy to the cent. S&P 7,671 (−0.17%), Nasdaq 26,798 (−0.09%) and Oracle 137.79 (+3.91%) match The Motley Fool.
- **Futures basis:** ES-SPX **+61.2** (Monday +66.6, Friday +60.3), YM-DJI +352, RTY-RUT +21.3. Normal December carry confirms these are settles, not stray live prints.
- **Risk-range series:** gold on TVC spot (43.3%) vs Comex front 41.7%; copper on OANDA spot (34.7%) vs Comex HG 48.1%. Crude and gas on continuous contracts as Hedgeye names them.
- **Band diff:** all 16 bands diffed against the Mon 28 Sep Early Look as reproduced in the archived 29 Sep PDF — not reopened on Hedgeye itself.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Brent:** the BZ1! row printed 96.16 **−9.12 (−8.66%)**. That compares December's settle with November's prior settle (105.28) across a contract roll. The true December move is −1.7% (Rigzone); the absolute change shown (≈ -1.66) is derived from that percentage, not captured.
- **Consumer confidence:** consensus **89.2** (Yahoo) vs **90** (Yahoo live blog); prior **88.6** vs **89.4** (revision). The miss is 7–8 points either way; the brief uses 89.2 / 88.6.
- **JOLTS:** consensus 7.228m (MarketScreener) vs 7.225m; prior 7.335m vs 7.271m. The BLS release page could not be fetched (404), so the actual 7.079m is secondary-sourced.
- **Nikkei:** TradingView close 65,481 (−0.60%) vs Invezz 65,071 (−1.2%). The Invezz figure reads as intraday; the brief uses TradingView.
- **FICO and Carnival:** not in the capture universe. FICO's move is reported between −20% and −27%; Carnival between +11.7% and +13%. Both are intraday marks from different times; no close is asserted.
- **Gold basis:** Comex GC1! at 4,179.70 sits \$3 under spot, against a ~\$40–49 premium on recent days. TradingView's continuous series appears to have rolled to a nearer contract; the Comex percentage is therefore not comparable with earlier editions. The spot band position is unaffected.

- **Tier 1 Alpha gamma levels and the \$30bn flow figure** reach this brief third-hand through an AI-generated summary. Treat them as directional.

KNOWN GAPS

- **Yahoo** returned nothing: no week-on-week bars and no second machine source for any row.
- **Hedgeye**: Top 3 Things, Chart of the Day, **MOMO Tracker** and **Crypto Quant** were not in the feed index; MOMO and Crypto Quant are the publications that would have carried momentum and crypto position changes. **Absence of a reported change there is not evidence there was none.** Signal Strength names were not extractable.
- **Quad path**: 2-2-1-2-2 is printed; the Macro Show's mention of an eventual Quad 4 is not reconciled with it. The Macro Week Summary Notes (25 Sep) were not reopened.
- **Calendar**: from one secondary source (TradingKey); ADP timing, China/HK holidays and the Tankan date are unconfirmed. Tesla delivery date unconfirmed.
- **Not captured**: Micron options-implied move; Dallas Fed actual; Fed speakers; IGV level.
- **After hours**: no major earnings landed 16:05-18:00 ET; Workday's -0.9% has no attributed cause.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window**: 06:09:37-06:09:39 GMT+8 (2.2 seconds). The run fired nine minutes after the nominal 06:00.
- **Session content of live rows**: futures **0 minutes** visible (10-minute delay, reopened 06:00); spot FX ~69 minutes (rolled 05:00); spot metals ~9 minutes; crypto continuous. Every change figure except crypto's is either Tuesday's move or noise.
- **Age of the stalest rows**: US cash and futures settles ~2.2 hours; European closes ~6.7 hours; Asian closes ~15.6 hours; the Early Look bands ~10.7 hours and published before Tuesday's session.
- **Superseded tonight**: risk ranges at ~19:30 GMT+8 (Wednesday Early Look); rates and the dollar at 20:30 (PCE); semis at 04:30 Thursday (Micron).
- **Verify live prices before acting**. Nothing in this brief is a recommendation.